

BHEL Established 1953

As India's largest engineering and manufacturing PSU, BHEL offers over 180 state-of-the-art products, from electric locomotives for the railways to supercritical boilers, turbines and steam generator sets for nuclear power plants

HEAVY DUTY

Powering India's growth, that too during the economic downturn has its hazards: high expectations and credible delivery. For K. Ravi Kumar, 60, outgoing chairman and managing director of Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd. (BHEL), a Navratna public sector undertaking (PSU) entrusted with building capacity and capability to meet the power forecast for the 11th Plan and beyond, it seemed a trust appropriately placed and carried out with unstinting commitment. BHEL sets have been generating 73 per cent of the total power generated in the country and installed equipment for over 90,000 MW of power generation, for utilities, captive and industrial users. Policy planners who set up BHEL in 1953 envisaged it as the vehicle to make India self-reliant in the manufacture of power plant equipment. "In a country with practically no industrial infrastructural base, it was easier said than done," says Kumar, who recalls how BHEL had to acquire technology from Russia and Czechoslovakia to build up a strong knowledge and skill base.

Led by Ravi Kumar's people-centric management mantra, BHEL's wealth creation has seen significant milestones, including many firsts like

51.5 per cent
is the share of the power generated by state government-run PSUs while 15.4% is contributed by those in the private sector.



K. Ravi Kumar 60, CMD*

* He retired in August and has been succeeded by B.P. Rao

"BHEL is now looking at nuclear power as its next growth driver. We are working to carry out exploration activities in India and abroad."

the completion of the first 1,000 MW coal-based turnkey project of the National Thermal Power Corporation in Andhra Pradesh in a record 39 months and introduction of new technologies like supercritical thermal sets in the field of coal and gas-based power plants using advanced class gas turbines in the country. BHEL has grabbed the largest-ever contract for the manufacture and supply of 150 electric locomotives for Indian Railways valued at Rs 990 crore. "BHEL achieved export orders from 22 coun-

tries in five continents, taking the company to an all-time high order inflow of Rs 10,254 crore last year," adds Kumar. Bucking the global recessionary trend, it has achieved a spectacular top line growth of 31 per cent, an all-time high turnover of Rs 28,033 crore and recorded its highest-ever net profit of Rs 3,138 crore.

With an order book of over Rs 1,17,000 crore, BHEL is readying to take on China as a formidable rival by equipping itself with technology, facilities and trained manpower. That's the power of BHEL.

by Nivedita Mukherjee